# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, September 15, 2026

## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

## THE LIST (5 stories)

### ■ *Renewable energy has finally grown fast enough to meet all new global electricity demand*

***The Angle:*** *For the first time ever, clean energy alone covered ALL the growth in global electricity demand — and solar just leapfrogged coal worldwide. Even China and India, the usual fossil-fuel growth engines, saw coal power actually drop.*

- For the first time ever, rising global electricity demand was **fully covered by clean power**, not fossil fuels
- **China** and **India** — historically the biggest drivers of fossil-fuel growth — both saw **falls in fossil generation**
- **Solar overtook coal** in the global electricity mix
- Renewables became the **world's largest source of electricity** for the first time in over a century

**The Big Picture Debate**

- Does a stat like this actually change how people think about climate progress, or does it fly under the radar completely?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://axis-intelligence.com/renewable-energy-statistics/?utm_source=copilot.com

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### ■ *Sony says gamers don't own their digital purchases, but 44 examples of its own wording suggest otherwise*

***The Angle:*** *Every gamer who's bought a digital title has wondered what happens when a platform pulls it - this one's got receipts, with Sony's own marketing language allegedly contradicting their legal position on ownership.*

- Sony is arguing in a case that gamers don't actually **own** the digital games they buy.
- Critics dug up **44 examples** of Sony's own wording - like "buy," "own," and "purchase" - used to sell those same digital titles.
- The contradiction is being called out as a showcase of the gap between marketing language and the fine print in digital licensing terms.

**The Debate Starter**

- If you've ever hit "buy now" on a digital game, movie, or album - do you actually think you own it, or did you already know you were just renting it?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113834-sony-gamers-dont-own-their-digital-purchases-but.html

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### ■ *Cops Search Thousands of Flock Cameras for Reasons of 'LMAO,' 'IDK,' 'Hehe,' and 'asdfg'*

***The Angle:*** *Police departments nationwide use Flock's license-plate camera network, and logs show officers justifying thousands of searches with nonsense like "IDK" and "asdfg" instead of an actual case reason - a viral, kind of hilarious, kind of terrifying look at how little oversight this surveillance system actually has.*

- Police reportedly ran **thousands** of searches through the **Flock** license-plate camera network
- Logged justifications for the searches included **"LMAO," "IDK," "Hehe,"** and **"asdfg"**
- Story is blowing up on **Reddit's r/technology** as a flashpoint for surveillance-oversight concerns

**The Debate Starter**

- If a cop can search a nationwide camera network and just type 'lol' as the reason, is anyone actually watching the watchers?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.404media.co/cops-search-thousands-of-flock-cameras-for-reasons-of-lmao-idk-hehe-and-asdfg/

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### ■ *Police Used Flock Camera Footage to Jail Innocent Woman for 13 Days: 'I Thought My Life Was Over'*

***The Angle:*** *This is the surveillance-state nightmare people worry about actually happening — a network of license plate cameras used by police departments nationwide reportedly helped jail a woman who did nothing wrong. It's a real gut-check on how much we should trust AI-assisted policing.*

- Police leaned on footage from **Flock** cameras — the license-plate-reading network used by thousands of departments across the country — to make the arrest.
- The woman spent **13 days** behind bars before it came out she was innocent.
- Her own words: **'I thought my life was over.'**

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you trust a camera network to correctly ID you as a criminal — and what happens when it doesn't?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techtimes.co.uk/florida-woman-flock-camera-misidentification-charges-dropped-1808662

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### ■ *US coal 'biggest contributor by far' to rise in global emissions*

***The Angle:*** *New data reportedly pins US coal as the single biggest driver behind the recent global spike in emissions — a real gut-check for a country that keeps talking green energy while coal plants stay online.*

- Report reportedly names **US coal** as the **"biggest contributor by far"** to the recent rise in global emissions.
- Limited source detail available beyond the headline claim — worth a fact-check on air before diving deep.

**The Debate Starter**

- Are we surprised coal's still this big a problem, or does it feel like old news dressed up as a headline?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thechemicalengineer.com/news/us-coal-biggest-contributor-by-far-to-rise-in-global-emissions/

Backup options:

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### ■ *EPA eliminates rule that limits planet-warming greenhouse gas emissions from power plants*

***The Angle:*** *This is a major federal rollback on climate policy that touches every American's power bill, air quality, and the bigger fight over how the U.S. handles global warming - the kind of story that splits a room fast.*

- The **EPA** has eliminated a federal rule capping greenhouse gas emissions from power plants.
- Power plants are among the **largest sources** of planet-warming pollution in the U.S.
- The move marks a major reversal in federal climate policy.

**The Debate Starter**

- Jobs and energy costs vs. the planet - where do you land on this one?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/epa-power-plants-trump-coal-gas-climate-cac1c2c75f8656d8eaf5f0a240edae15?link_source=ta_thread_link&taid=6aa82d119b759200017de8be&utm_campaign=trueanthem&utm_medium=social&utm_source=threads.net

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### ■■ *"Offensively cheap": Solar power is looking up*

***The Angle:*** *Solar power costs have reportedly dropped so low that the internet is calling it "offensively cheap" - a trend that touches everyone's power bill and could reshape how North America thinks about energy*

*long-term.*

- Reddit's r/futurology is buzzing over solar power getting dramatically, almost comically cheap
- The framing - **"offensively cheap"** - suggests costs have dropped further/faster than people expected
- Signals solar may be tipping from niche green option to straight-up cheapest energy play

**The Debate Starter**

- If solar's basically free now, why is your power bill still brutal - who's pocketing the difference?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/gadgets/2026/09/offensively-cheap-solar-power-is-looking-up/

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## CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

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### ■■ *NDP upsets UCP stronghold in Calgary-Shaw in byelection results*

***The Angle:*** *A byelection upset in a riding UCP has held onto for years is the kind of result that gets read as a bellwether for how Albertans are feeling about the provincial government right now.*

- **Calgary-Shaw** flipped from **UCP** to **NDP** in the byelection
- The riding had been considered a **UCP stronghold** heading into the vote
- Byelection results like this are often read province-wide as a signal on the sitting government's popularity

**The Debate Starter**

- Is this a real crack in UCP support, or just a sleepy byelection where a low turnout swung things?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/calgary/article/ndp-upsets-ucp-stronghold-in-calgary-shaw-in-byelection-results/

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### 🛩■ *Canada will seek private investment at 4 largest airports, Carney tells summit*

***The Angle:*** *Mark Carney says Canada will court private investment at Toronto Pearson, Vancouver, Calgary and Montreal — a shift that could mean higher fees, new terminals, or a foreign stake in the gates you walk through every trip.*

- **PM Mark Carney** floated the plan at an international summit
- The **4 largest airports** in the country are the target: **Toronto**, **Vancouver**, **Calgary**, **Montreal**
- Move signals Canada opening up airport ownership/funding to **private investors**

**The Debate Starter**

- Private money fixing your terminal, or private money hiking your parking and fees — which happens first?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/livestory/carney-investment-summit-tariffs-trillion-protests-9.7344307?cmp=rss

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### ■ *COVID-19 benefit repayment is hurting low-income Canadians, report says*

***The Angle:*** *Years after the pandemic, Canadians are still being asked to repay COVID-era benefits, and a new report says the clawbacks are landing hardest on people who can least afford it — a fairness fight that hits close to home for a lot of listeners.*

- A new report says Canadians are still being asked to **repay pandemic-era COVID-19 benefits**.
- The repayment burden is falling hardest on **low-income Canadians**, according to the report.

**The Fairness Debate**

- Should the government still be clawing back pandemic benefit money from people who can barely make rent right now?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/cra-pandemic-benefit-clawbacks-cerb-cra-maytree-report-9.7330433?cmp=rss

Backup options:

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### ■■ *Alberta NDP win in Calgary-Shaw byelection*

***The Angle:*** *A byelection upset in Calgary-Shaw is a real gut-check for Alberta's ruling UCP — a seat swing this narrow signals cracks in provincial politics worth flagging for Canadian listeners.*

- NDP's **Kyle Campbell** won the **Calgary-Shaw** byelection over UCP's **Mike Derry**
- The margin was just **582 votes**
- Results are unofficial, from **Elections Alberta**

**The Debate Starter**

- A 582-vote swing in a UCP stronghold — is this buyer's remorse setting in on Alberta's government?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/calgary-shaw-byelection-results-alberta-ndp-9.7344149?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Heavy rain turns half-marathon into total soak-a-thon | The Moment*

***The Angle:*** *Flash flooding turned a routine road race into a wade-through-your-shins ordeal, and the runner's play-by-play of it is the kind of wild-weather story that makes for an easy, relatable chat.*

- **Julia Cairns** was mid-race when flash floods swamped the course.
- The half-marathon in **Paramus, New Jersey** left runners partially submerged in floodwater.
- She detailed the soggy ordeal in an interview with **CBC's The National**.

**The Phone-In Trigger**

- Would you have kept running through the floodwater or called it quits on the spot?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7344145?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Iconic winter X Games comes to Calgary*

***The Angle:*** *The X Games haven't had a proper winter home in years, and now Calgary's landing it - a huge get for the city and a big deal for Canadian winter sports fans who usually watch this stuff happen in the US.*

- The **X Games** are heading to **Calgary** in **February** next year
- **WinSport's Canada Olympic Park** is hosting
- It's a **three-day event** kicking off **Feb. 19**

**The Local Pride Angle**

- Would you actually brave a Calgary February to watch this live, or is this strictly a TV event for you?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/calgary-winter-sports-x-games-9.7343723?cmp=rss

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## ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

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### ■ *'Lanterns' Burns It All Down: Episode 5 Director Explains John Stewart's Shocking Decision - TheWrap*

***The Angle:*** *Episode 5 of HBO's new 'Lanterns' series went full scorched-earth with John Stewart's storyline, and the director is now explaining why they blew it up with three episodes still to go — perfect fuel for a spoiler-warning superhero chat.*

- Director **Geeta Vasant Patel** sat down with **TheWrap** to break down Episode 5's twist.
- The show reportedly "burned it all down" around **John Stewart's** arc mid-season.
- There are still **three episodes** left in the season after this gut-punch.
- Patel says the chaos was designed to keep the character, not the spectacle, front and center.

**The Spoiler Alert Debate**

- Would you rather a show blow up its own story mid-season or save the twist for the finale?

TheWrap (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thewrap.com/creative-content/tv-shows/lanterns-episode-5-is-john-stewart-still-green-lantern-director-interview/

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## ■ *David Harbour teases his secret action project with Millie Bobby Brown that's in development at Netflix:*

***The Angle:*** *Two "Stranger Things" faves are apparently cooking up an action project together at Netflix, and Harbour's teasing a grown-up father-daughter dynamic as his onscreen kid ages out of the show that made them both stars.*

- **David Harbour** teased a secret action project with **Millie Bobby Brown** in development at **Netflix**
- Harbour says they have a **father-daughter dynamic** he thinks "we play very well"
- He notes **Brown** is "now in her **20s**" and they want to explore fathering someone at that age vs. the teen dynamic from **Stranger Things**
- Quote: "he's going through all kinds of things" too - both characters navigating change

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you watch a Harbour/Brown action spin-off, or does it feel too soon to leave Hawkins behind?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2099832603574678001

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## ■ *Stephen Colbert declares "free speech is alive and well" after winning the #Emmy for Best Variety Series, despite CBS' cancellation of "The*

***The Angle:*** *Colbert just won Best Variety Series months after CBS axed "The Late Show" — and used his acceptance speech to take a not-so-subtle victory lap on free speech, which is exactly the kind of awkward, watercooler-ready moment awards shows are made for.*

- **Stephen Colbert** won the **Emmy for Best Variety Series**
- The win comes after **CBS** cancelled **"The Late Show"**
- Colbert said: **"free speech is alive and well"**
- He gave a shoutout to fellow late-night hosts: **"Jimmy and Jimmy and John and John and Seth"**

**The Debate Starter**

- Is this a classy mic-drop moment or Colbert twisting the knife on his way out the door?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2099719384751341845

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## ■ *'Sydney Sweeney's Ad Disrespects Every Woman': Female Athletes Slam Sexualised Sports Campaign*

***The Angle:*** *A Sydney Sweeney ad campaign is getting called out by real female athletes for leaning into sex appeal over sport, and the blunt "disrespects every woman" quote is exactly the kind of soundbite that fuels a real debate about how brands sell women's sports.*

- Female athletes are publicly slamming the campaign as **overly sexualized**
- One critic's quote cuts right to it: **"Disrespects every woman"**
- The backlash centers on **Sydney Sweeney** fronting a sports-branded campaign

**The Debate Starter**

- Does this ad actually disrespect female athletes, or are people reading too much into it?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/sydney-sweeney-novig-sports-campaign-backlash-1763946

Backup options:

## ■ *Tyler Perry Announces Plans to Move to Puerto Rico, Says He's 'Pulling Back a Whole Lot' from Work*

***The Angle:*** *One of the biggest names in Hollywood says he's stepping back from the grind and relocating - that's a real 'wait, what?' moment for anyone who's watched him build an empire from the ground up.*

- **Tyler Perry** announced plans to move to **Puerto Rico**
- He says he's **"pulling back a whole lot"** from work
- Comes after decades of nonstop output - studios, films, TV shows

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you ever walk away from a hustle that made you a billionaire to slow down - or is that a myth nobody actually does?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/tyler-perry-moving-to-puerto-rico-pulling-back-a-whole-lot-from-work-12120802

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## ■ *Michael J. Fox Earns Huge Emmys Ovation and Inspires Tears as He Accepts Humanitarian Award: 'Accepting Parkinson's Didn't Mean I Had to Surrender to It'*

***The Angle:*** *A rare unscripted, emotional moment at an awards show always plays well on air, and Fox's line about living with Parkinson's is the kind of quote that gets repeated all week.*

- **Michael J. Fox** received the **Governors Award** (humanitarian honor) at the **Emmys**
- He got a standing ovation from the room
- Key quote: **"Accepting Parkinson's didn't mean I had to surrender to it"**
- Moment reportedly moved the audience to tears

**The Feel-Good Beat**

- What's a line from a celebrity that's actually stuck with you and changed how you think?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/michael-j-fox-emmy-humanitarian-parkinsons-1236861934/

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## ■ *Macklemore speaks out after being dropped from Ed Sheeran's tour following his 'Free Palestine' speech; says Gillette Stadium owner Robert Kraft rallied other stadium owners and gave Ed Sheeran an ultimatum: if Macklemore stayed on tour, then Ed would not be able to play in their venues.*

***The Angle:*** *A 'Free Palestine' speech on stage allegedly triggered a stadium-owner power play big enough to bump a headliner from a global tour — that's a juicy mix of politics, music, and NFL money hitting all at once.*

- **Macklemore** claims he was dropped from **Ed Sheeran's** tour after giving a **'Free Palestine'** speech during a show.
- He says **Patriots/Gillette Stadium owner Robert Kraft** rallied other stadium owners to push him off the bill.
- The alleged ultimatum: keep **Macklemore** on tour, and **Ed Sheeran** loses access to those stadiums entirely.
- Macklemore is now speaking out publicly about getting pushed out over the incident.

**The Debate Starter**

- Should a stadium owner be able to bench an opener over a political statement, or is that Sheeran's call alone?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wg73id

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## ■ *Ms Rachel calls out Ed Sheeran and says we all need to speak on what is happening*

***The Angle:*** *Ms Rachel is basically the patron saint of toddler YouTube, so when she publicly calls out a pop star this big, fans immediately want the tea — it's the kind of celebrity-vs-celebrity moment that spreads fast on social before anyone even knows the full story.*

**The Missing Context Alert**

- All we've got is a headline right now, so before we react on air, let's track down what Ms Rachel actually said Ed Sheeran did.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/k28majyocjph1.jpeg

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## TRENDING TODAY

### ■ *Wavytalk's viral blow dryer brush is on a major sale before October Prime Day*

***The Angle:*** *This blow-out brush has been all over social media for making salon-style hair happen at home, and now it's discounted before Prime Day even kicks off - which means listeners want to know if it's worth grabbing early.*

- The **Wavytalk** blow dryer brush is getting a price cut ahead of **October Prime Day**
- It's built to combine drying and styling in one step for an at-home blowout
- The brush has developed a viral following for cutting down styling time

**The Deal Check**

- Callers - what's the one viral gadget you actually bought and don't regret?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/15/shopping/wavytalk-thermal-brush-is-under-50-before-prime-day/

Backup options:

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### ■ *'I'm Black I Can't Be Racist': Minnesota Wendy's Customer Draws Backlash After Allegedly Threatening to Call ICE on Hispanic Workers*

***The Angle:*** *A viral clash over race, immigration, and fast food service is blowing up online because the customer's own defense — "I'm Black, I can't be racist" — is now the most-quoted line in the whole story.*

- Incident happened at a **Wendy's in Minnesota**
- Customer allegedly threatened to **call ICE** on **Hispanic employees**
- Customer's defense, caught on video: **"I'm Black I can't be racist"**
- Clip is drawing heavy **backlash** online, first surfaced via **r/nottheonion**

**The Debate Starter**

- Can weaponizing ICE against coworkers ever be defended as 'not racist' just because of who's saying it?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thenerdstash.com/im-black-i-cant-be-racist-minnesota-wendys-customer-draws-backlash-after-allegedly-threatening-to-call-ice-on-hispanic-workers/

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### ■ *Sydney Sweeney's 'sexualized' sports betting ad slammed by Canadian athletes*

***The Angle:*** *Sweeney's already a lightning rod after her American Eagle ad blew up online, and now a 'sexualized' sports betting campaign has real athletes calling foul — this is the kind of ad-backlash story built for two hosts to actually argue about.*

- **Sydney Sweeney** is facing backlash again — this time over a **sports betting ad** critics are calling '**sexualized**.'
- **Female athletes**, including ones in **Canada**, are speaking out against the campaign.
- Sweeney's own **response** to the criticism has added fuel to the fire, not calmed it down.

**The Debate Starter**

- Is this genuine exploitation in advertising, or is everyone just primed to pile on Sydney Sweeney right now?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/sydney-sweeney-sports-ad-9.7342823?cmp=rss

## LIFESTYLE CHAT

### ■ *Benny Blanco Reveals the Secret to Winning Over Selena Gomez When They Began Dating - people.com*

***The Angle:*** *Benny Blanco and Selena Gomez are engaged and fans can't get enough of their love story, so any new detail on how the producer wooed a global pop star is instant lifestyle-segment gold.*

**The Debate Starter**

- What's the one move that's actually worked for you when trying to win someone over?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMisAFBVV95cUxQNVB5WDNpUmRqaDZjc3Q2UTZqM3I3RU1kSjk5cHJwTjJmaUxsVjhFbVIweWVUYVcyYmdFOVZ4UnlsMENJMzIRZkgtVkZEVWxxc2lfNWIyQ2w5UWJtNTR6ZkJBbjJobkdNQnJMbmxiVXNnWk85OWZLSmZBMlpYQjVYTVZvOE5nQ1c0TXZQaGpiQnJzcFM4RjMwcTJ3UzAwcjZiSFI0TGdOZTJFY1ZQUUxPVw?oc=5

Backup options:

### ■■ *A College Girl Was Exploited on Camera. A Network of Anonymous Men Got to Work | Maddie Kowalski is one of countless young women who've had their lives destroyed by the burnerverse, a loosely connected online community of sports fans. Now she's fighting back*

***The Angle:*** *It's a real, spreading corner of internet culture — anonymous sports-fan accounts building coordinated campaigns against ordinary young women — and it's a cautionary tale about online safety that hits close to home for anyone with a teenage daughter, niece, or younger sister on social media.*

- **Maddie Kowalski**, a college student, says her life was upended by a network she calls the '**burnerverse**.'
- The 'burnerverse' is described as a **loosely connected online community of sports fans**.
- She says she's far from the only one — **'countless' young women** have reportedly been targeted the same way.
- She's now speaking out publicly and, per the story's framing, **'fighting back.'**

**The Awareness Check**

- Ask listeners: had you ever heard the term 'burnerverse' before today — and does it change how you think about who's really behind an anonymous fan account?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wired.com/story/burnerverse-maddie-kowalski/

### ■ *A new study reveals that individuals with dark personality traits tend to achieve greater creative success because they possess a highly analytical, self-directed thinking style that allows them to bypass social norms and external constraints.*

***The Angle:*** *New research links so-called 'dark' personality traits to bigger creative success, and the reason isn't chaos - it's a sharp, self-directed way of thinking that just ignores the rules everyone else follows. Instant debate fuel: are the most brilliant people in any room also the hardest to deal with?*

- The study connects **'dark personality traits'** to higher **creative success**
- The theory: it comes from a highly **analytical, self-directed thinking style**
- That mindset lets people **bypass social norms and external constraints** that box others in

**The Debate Starter**

- Think of the most brilliant person you know who's also kind of impossible - does this explain them?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/a-specific-thinking-style-explains-why-dark-personality-traits-are-linked-to-creativity/

## CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

### ■ *A Cop Searched 19,000 Flock Cameras Across 1,558 Cities. His Reason: 'LMAO'*

***The Angle:*** *A police officer allegedly ran a search across 19,000 Flock surveillance cameras in over 1,500 cities and the reason logged for the search was literally "LMAO" - a perfect, absurd flashpoint in the ongoing debate over how much access cops have to mass surveillance networks.*

- An officer searched **19,000 Flock Safety cameras** spanning **1,558 cities**
- The stated reason field for the search was just **"LMAO"**
- Flock cameras are license-plate reading cameras used by police departments across the US and Canada
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, framed as too absurd to be satire

**The Debate Starter**

- If a cop can search 19,000 cameras nationwide and just write "LMAO" as the reason, who's actually checking that log?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techtimes.co.uk/police-flock-search-licence-plate-lmao-1808683

Backup options:

### ■ *Woman throws bucket of poop on neighbor for sleeping with her husband, deputies say*

***The Angle:*** *This is peak 'Florida Man' energy — a revenge story so petty and specific it practically writes its own punchline, perfect for a quick KICKER laugh before the goodbye.*

- A **woman** is accused of dumping a **bucket of feces** on her neighbor
- The alleged motive: the neighbor was **sleeping with her husband**
- **Deputies** got involved and confirmed the incident

**The Verdict**

- Justified petty revenge or straight-up assault charge — where do you land?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kwtx.com/2026/09/14/woman-throws-bucket-poop-neighbor-sleeping-with-her-husband-deputies-say/?fbclid=IwdGRjcAUVGb5wZG9mBWZkaWQWUOaOUzImJhBVuctc4K8QjpSPhm7u12V4dG4DYWVtAjExAHNydGMGYXBwX2lkCjY2Mjg1NjgzNzkAAR76dqupBuVi5YnAgeDyGlwtbxzXTWWjEMeddrNv7kkh1mp9Alx-1JqKiwyLpA_aem_9uFVgH4eah1PRry2wXCh4A

## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

### ■ *Uber CEO says laying off 3,300 workers will help lower prices for customers*

***The Angle:*** *Corporate spin doesn't get much bolder than "we're cutting thousands of jobs to save YOU money" - it's the kind of line that sounds like satire, which is exactly why it's blowing up online.*

- **Uber's CEO** says laying off **3,300 workers** will help lower prices for riders
- The story took off on **r/nottheonion** - people assumed it had to be a joke headline

**The Corporate Spin Translator**

- Every time a CEO says a layoff is 'for the customer,' who do you think it's really for - you, or the shareholders?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**
- **Step 1: Read the Headline Straight** - Deadpan delivery -> Host reads the Uber CEO quote completely straight, no reaction, like it's normal business news.
- **Step 2: Corporate-Speak Translator** - 30-second bit -> Co-host "translates" the quote into plain English - what a layoff-as-customer-benefit line actually means.
- **Step 3: Round Up More Examples** - Crowdsource on air -> Ask listeners to text in the most tone-deaf corporate spin line they've ever heard from a CEO.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113822-uber-ceo-laying-off-3300-workers-help-lower.html

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## BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

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### ■ *Christian Bale opens Palmdale village built to keep foster brothers and sisters together*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A recognizable A-list name (Christian Bale) doing something unexpectedly tender and specific — building a literal village to keep foster siblings together — is the kind of surprising-actor-does-good story that outperforms typical celebrity news.
***The Angle:*** *A-list actor turned real estate developer — Batman is building homes so foster siblings don't get split up, and that's the kind of feel-good celebrity story that actually has substance behind it.*

- **Christian Bale** helped open a new foster care village in **Palmdale, California**
- The project is designed to keep foster **brothers and sisters together**, instead of splitting siblings up across different homes
- Sibling separation is one of the most common heartbreaks in the foster system — this village is built specifically to solve that

**The Feel-Good Hook**
- Did you know most foster kids with siblings get split into different homes — would you have guessed a Hollywood A-lister would be the one building a fix?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://sheets.works/story/a-village-for-brothers-and-sisters?r=game

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### ■ *'Smart' underwear that counts your farts*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Absurd novelty tech ('smart underwear that counts farts') is prime meme/screenshot bait for r/nottheonion-style spread — it's funny, easy to summarize in one line, and shareable without any context.
***The Angle:*** *It's the kind of gloriously dumb invention the internet was built to mock — a wearable that turns your gas into data, which is exactly the kind of pointless-but-hilarious story that makes a killer goodbye segment.*

**The Overshare Alert**
- Would you actually wear underwear that snitches on your gas to an app?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/news/science/fart-tracker-underwear-b2919610.html

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### ■ *Tech billionaire Peter Thiel bringing Antichrist lectures to Nashville*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Peter Thiel + 'Antichrist lectures' is a genuinely bizarre, specific pairing of a major tech name with fringe theological content — that kind of dissonance drives curiosity clicks and quote-tweet dunking alike.
***The Angle:*** *A Silicon Valley billionaire touring the country giving lectures on the literal Antichrist is exactly the kind of "wait, what?" story that gets shared - it's a strange collision of tech money, politics, and apocalyptic*

*theology that people can't help but talk about.*

**The Wait, What? Moment**

- Would you actually pay to sit through a tech billionaire's lecture on the Antichrist?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.yahoo.com/news/us/articles/tech-billionaire-peter-thiel-bringing-202027251.html?guccounter=1&guce_referrer=aHR0cHM6Ly93d3cuZ29vZ2xlLmNvbS8&guce_referrer_sig=AQAAAMvW0WF7ztq0H2V4M1e_6A_OME4RgK3V8I_0pM_aNt8DHqj0rEzY6IoRUB8VBBjbemATFAqAr9c2Rcc9XszsnVLrrojZ346mew6nB1yYzebBcLgfwevAP6KgccSuiW9vFkhnd1WaxefNuGGiAaK8QnIEOJyNU4JwXIi3mkI-cDwx

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## ■ *Ed Sheeran 'deserves no applause' after axing Macklemore from tour over Palestine drama*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The Sheeran/Macklemore Palestine tour-drop story also appears independently via CTVNews (index 39), meaning it's already generating cross-platform pickup — a concrete momentum signal plus a built-in controversy hook.
***The Angle:*** *A pop superstar bouncing a fellow artist from his tour over a Palestine-related dust-up is exactly the kind of celebrity-meets-politics story that splits a room fast - is this about keeping a tour 'safe,' or silencing an artist for speaking out?*

- **Ed Sheeran** reportedly axed **Macklemore** from an upcoming tour lineup.
- The fallout ties back to **Macklemore's** vocal stance on **Palestine**.
- Backlash online includes claims **Sheeran 'deserves no applause'** for the call.

**The Debate Starter**

- Should artists ever get bumped from a tour over their political statements, or is that flat-out censorship?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.irishstar.com/culture/entertainment/ed-sheeran-macklemore-free-palestine-37664657

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## ■ *Fashion and costume designer Bob Mackie, who helped stars sparkle, dies age 87*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Bob Mackie's death is being covered independently by both r/entertainment and Billboard (index 49), and iconic-designer obituaries with decades of celebrity photos ('helped stars sparkle') tend to generate strong nostalgic tribute engagement.
***The Angle:*** *Bob Mackie spent decades defining what glamour looks like on stage and screen, so his passing is a genuine pop-culture moment worth pausing on, not just an industry footnote.*

- Fashion and costume designer **Bob Mackie** has died at age **87**
- He built his reputation dressing stars in show-stopping, sparkle-heavy looks for stage and screen

**The Tribute Moment**

- Ask listeners: what's the most iconic sparkly, over-the-top stage look you remember - odds are a Bob Mackie design is behind it.

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.cnn.com/2026/09/14/style/bob-mackie-fashion-designer-dead?utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=missions&utm_source=reddit

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# FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)

- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary ‘B’Day’ Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "‘A modern Dickie Dee bike’: Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)

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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-15 09:46 AM